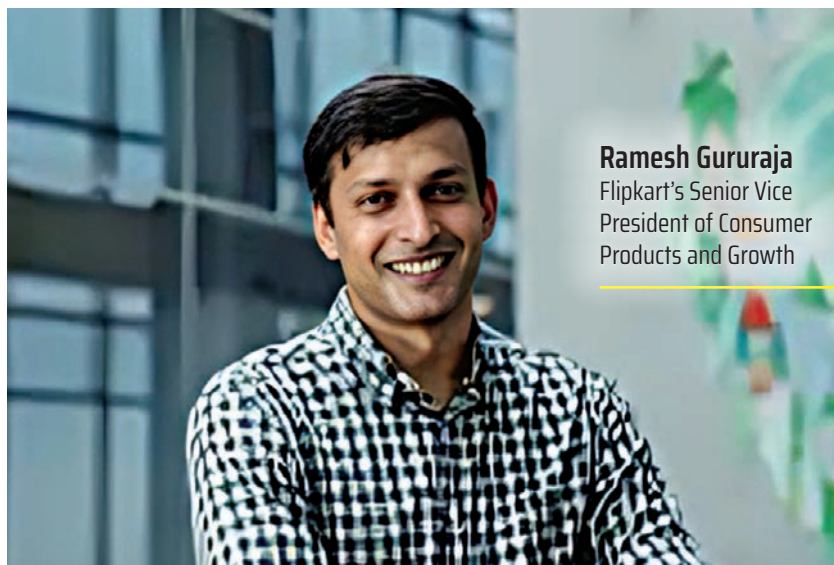




Ramesh Gururaja
Flipkart's Senior Vice
President of Consumer
Products and Growth

Flipkart's big bet

On creator-fuelled commerce in India

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At a crowded event in Mumbai, Flipkart's Ramesh Gururaja is painting a vivid picture. He's describing a modular space where creators can film product demos in professionally lit booths that can shift, quite literally, from a Santorini kitchen to a Chennai beach overnight. It sounds part film set, part shopping mall, and entirely unlike anything in the current Indian commerce experience.

"This is physical infrastructure for a digital-first mindset," says Ramesh Gururaja, Flipkart's Senior Vice President of Consumer Products and Growth. With over two decades of experience building platforms at Microsoft, Amazon, and Tokopedia, Ramesh isn't just speculating. He's someone who's helped scale logistics and commerce tech across multiple Asian markets. "We're building spaces that are dynamic, modular, and

equipped with everything creators need to make commerce-centric content – lighting, sets, even tech that makes the booth feel like a film set one day, and a smart home the next."

Welcome to the next chapter in Indian e-commerce – where shopping isn't just transactional, it's theatrical.

Flipkart's betting on content as infrastructure

According to Gururaja, Creator Cities initiative is Flipkart's answer to a problem that's been brewing just beneath the surface of India's e-commerce boom – discovery. While millions browse and buy online, Ramesh believes the infrastructure to support meaningful, creator-led content hasn't scaled to its full potential yet.

"If you look at China's evolution, we're seven to eight years behind," he says, referencing the live commerce ecosystems of platforms like Taobao

and JD.com. "In India, we have the creators, the ambition, and even the tech platforms. What's missing is the connective tissue between physical and digital."

That tissue, in Flipkart's vision, starts with Creator Cities and extends through smart integrations within its platform. The idea is deceptively simple, outlines Ramesh. Creators produce video content tied to products – say, a red dress or a kitchen appliance – and those videos dynamically show up in relevant search results across Flipkart. But enabling all of that requires a backend symphony.

"We need to know, at a meta-data level, where exactly in a video a product is being shown or discussed," Ramesh explains. "It's not just text anymore. It's voice, video, and gestures. We're building systems that can read video content and map it precisely to consumer intent."

The result of all that tech wizardry will pretty soon lead to a shopper searching for a "non-stick dosa tawa" might not just see images or specs – but a creator demonstrating its sizzle, live. You can't fault Ramesh Gururaja or Flipkart's scale of ambition!

Gen Z is watching

While Flipkart's bet on content creation feels futuristic, it's being propelled by a very current force, according to Ramesh – India's Gen Z.

"These are users who care about trends more than brands," says Ramesh. "They want authenticity, relatability and they want community."

He breaks it down into three pillars. First, the influence of "genuine content" – not polished ad spots, but creator-driven videos that feel raw and honest. Second, the rise of small-group social commerce, where private friend circles influence each other's buys. And third, a shift in language – not just regional, but tonal. **d**

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